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Ethical issues in the Challenger disaster

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1. Did NASA knowingly take extra risks because of pressure to maintain Congressional funding? What would be a solution to this issue?

I don't think NASA took extra risks only because of pressure to maintain Congressional funding, but also because NASA was eager to protect its reputation. Also there was a problem with bureaucracy and communication problems between space engineers, and their superiors (managers). Communication should have been clearer so less misunderstanding and delay would be caused. Also, there was a flaw in the rocket design, which indicated the O-rings had a problem functioning at cold variable. Maybe they didn't carefully consider temperature as a variable in designing the O-rings, they rather looked it over. Also, in the President Commission Report, there was no evidence that NASA did the mistake because they lacked the funding.

The most important solution is that it is better for delays and cancellations rather than compromising safety.

2. Did Thiokol knowingly take extra risks for fear of losing its contract with NASA? What would be a solution to this issue?

No, there was no indication that Thiol feared losing its contract with NASA. The reason why Nasa also used second supplier other than Thiol was thanks to lobbying by Thiol's competitions. So the problem is to bureaucracy (managers didn't want to listen to rocket engineers and scientists' warnings), communication problem, and technical problem in the rocket regarding pressure and temperature.